



July 1st 2019 Delaware County Commissioners Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PaSmvIEBLkE
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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: Monday, July 1, 2019

Location: Delaware County, Indiana

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order at [00:00:07](#) on Monday, July 1, 2019, by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:** Commissioners present included Mr. King, Mr. Henry, and Ms. Regan.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** [00:00:34](#) The board held a moment of faith and remembrance to honor the passing of former commissioner Larry Crouch.
- **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the transcript narrative, though procedural votes immediately followed).*

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:30 Land Resources / Probation Appointments Table**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Commissioners / Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed tabling business concerning land resources and probation appointments (noting that Pawnee Community Corrections appointments should instead appear on the agenda for the 15th).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to table business passed unanimously by voice vote (00:01:34).
 - **00:02:32 Contract: Bridge Replacement on 600 West over York Prairie Creek**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Highway / Engineering Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** This contract is necessary to secure federal funding toward construction. The project is slated to go to letting in February.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:02:52).
 - **00:03:00 Contract: Tree Removal (Industrial Center)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Loekle / Highway Department (working with Frank).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Contract covers tree removal in the industrial center as part of a redevelopment project. Reviewed by legal counsel with no problems found.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Advanced/Acknowledged for execution.
 - **00:03:51 Resolution 2019-024: Highway Department Work Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jesse / Highway Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Under state statutes, the commissioners must approve any highway department work exceeding \$100,000. Mr. Jesse determined that using internal county employees and department resources is more cost-effective than contracting out.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Resolution 2019-024 approved by voice vote (00:04:29).
 - **00:04:53 Economic Development (EDIT) Plan**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Economic Development Officials.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of the draft 3-year EDIT plan (effective July 1, 2019 through June 30, 2022) following a series of meetings with towns and the county. Projections factor in data from the State Board of Accounts and financial consultants.
 - **00:13:41 Claims Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Auditor / Financial Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of claims totaling \$5,432,760.49.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion for payment of claims approved by voice vote (00:13:47).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:14:04 Terry Hyphens (Ball State University Lecturer)**
 - Introduced seven journalism students from Soochow University in China participating in a “1+2+1” dual-degree program who were attending the meeting to observe the American legislative and local government process.
- **00:15:15 Linda (Representing the League of Women Voters)**
 - **Key Concerns:** Addressed ongoing public confusion regarding city vs. county Emergency Medical Services (EMS) plans and 911 dispatch integration. Asked if the commissioners would participate in an open public forum organized by the League of Women Voters to help clear up public confusion.
 - **Board & Staff Response:** Jason (Emergency Management Director) expressed frustration over the immense time spent responding to repetitive Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) requests and gathering data that is frequently overlooked or misconstrued by the public and city officials. The commissioners and Council President Quackenbush detailed ongoing communication roadblocks with the City of Muncie, the Muncie Mayor, and the hospital regarding lack of operational plans, unappropriated city spending on ambulances, and potential risks to paramedic staffing and Advanced Life Support (ALS) intercepts.
- **00:12:11 (Note: Remarks by County Council President Quackenbush)**
 - Spoke earlier during administrative discussions to inform the commissioners that the County Council advised departments to submit their budgets as if nothing has changed, offering 100% support for current county-managed emergency operations.
- **00:28:28 Brian Button (Harrison Township Resident)**
 - **Key Concerns:** Inquired about county mowing ordinances and procedures for handling overgrown grass and neglected lots in residential additions (as opposed to farm fields), noting issues with snakes and lack of local enforcement clarity.
 - **Staff Response:** Advised that he would follow up with an email detailing procedures, noting potential past reliance on township trustees or the Board of Health.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Discussion regarding sending another formal letter to the Muncie mayor requesting a meeting to clarify EMS plans, dispatch protocols, and the use of the 800 MHz radio system.
 - Mention of upcoming meetings and budget preparations.
- **Adjournment:** **00:30:34** The meeting moved toward a recess/adjournment.

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